

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

Gratitude practice has made its way into the mainstream over the last decade or so, with most people working in the wellbeing space agreeing that it plays a huge role in fostering feelings of happiness and fulfilment. Regular active gratitude can help you to move that set point of happiness over time, because it helps you to pull what you have into sharp focus, rather than putting all of the emphasis on what you don't have. It's easy to see how this could also benefit your financial wellbeing at the same time as making you feel generally happier – it's one of the places where the link is strongest. Many different courses and plans to improve wellbeing include daily gratitudes – focussing on just two or three things that you are grateful for, which you either write down or actively think about – and I believe this has a key role in your journey towards financial health. It helps to strengthen the muscles that you need to fight off the constant torrent of FOMO marketing, and reduces the need to keep levelling up. We'll talk about gratitude practice and how to develop rituals and habits around it a little more in Step Three.

As with gratitude, many of the recommended techniques for beating hedonic adaption are repeated actions rather than single events, which they also have in common with some of the habits and rituals that we'll talk about later. A couple of things to try to incorporate into your daily life now, in the hope of shifting that happiness set point even just a few degrees in the right direction and reducing that feeling of needing to constantly level up your earning, spending and lifestyle choices, are: